

Yavuz Erkan

Bachelor of Photography

UNORTHODOX APHORISMS

2011

archival pigment prints on Hahnemuhle photo rag paper

each 50.0 x 50.0 cm

Voyeurism can be a dangerous thing. Fast and unconsidered judgements can be made based on a person's clothing, behaviour and speech. In some instances this may provide access to a person of apparently similar sympathies, in others it may inhibit contact altogether.

Yavuz Erkan's photographic series *UNORTHODOX APHORISMS* invites the viewer to 'distance themselves from their conventional routines' of assessment.¹ In a series, instead of a single image, these works form a portrait based on actions rather than visage. The viewer is encouraged to consider another individual in a quiet and considerate manner, rather than superficially or in haste.

Each image presents an action connected to the mundane, subverted by an individual's personalised style. The tonal range across the artist's palette is consistent, the images carefully composed, the subject ever present, seemingly to exploit the position that 'straight' portraiture is not enough. After all, orthodox aphorisms, or short pithy maxims, often just promote face value.

The unique world of this subject is offered openly and honestly, with arms out stretched to the viewer. An alternate perspective has something to offer the more considerate traveller. These images offer simple pleasures via various forms of reconsideration. Here it appears normal to delight in the textural and tactile aspects of everyday existence – to feel the grit of sand on your back or the squishiness of jelly in your fingers. Milk and tomatoes are not mere units of consumption, but rather precious experiential objects. A bubble is savoured, while other items are contemplated at length.

In this series Erkan offers difference as strength. Or at the very least, difference as a form of value not to be dismissed or ignored.

Yavuz Erkan is currently completing a Bachelor of Photography. He also holds a Bachelor of Science from the Istanbul Technical University. He has exhibited within Australia and abroad. His work is held in private and public collections including the Monash University Museum of Art Collection.

Camille Serisier

¹ Reference